

Tips & Tricks

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Workshop

Learn how to make Google your personal automation slave with Google Apps Scripting

Dated configs, over-heating laptops and impossible overclocking...

Digit's tireless reviewers do their best to help out their ailing readers in times of need. How do you overclock a laptop? What do you do with a finicky Wi-Fi setup and when do you know if your device is faulty? We're here to help.

Set top box USB trouble

I am regular reader of Digit Magazine, I have the following problem: My TV Cable operator has provided the Aspire 5000 series set top box. The set top box has an inbuilt USB port. The remote of the set-top box shows that the device is capable of recording content. But when I insert a pen drive or a portable external hard drive, the set top box doesn't detect it. The manual of the set-top box says that you must use USB 2.0 drives and the power it intakes should be less than 0.5A. Kindly let me know which pen drives use power less than 0.5A.

Noel Castelino

A This is one of the most common problems arising in set-top-boxes. Most of them advertise that they support recording through a USB device but there are only a few good ones in the market that properly do so. Some of these set-top-boxes do work nicely, but sometimes an issue arises due to the cable operator itself. In your case if you are connecting a pen drive and are not able to detect it through the set-top-box, then there might be something wrong with the set-top-box itself because all regular pen drives require less power than 500mA or 0.5A as USB 2.0 ports have a standard power output of 0.5A per port unless otherwise specified. As for connecting an external hard drive to the set-top-box, it might not work because some external hard drives require more juice to get powered on.

Overclocking a laptop

Hi guys, after reading your article on overclocking in the April issue, I tried overclocking my Dell Latitude E5500

laptop but I am unable to do so. What is the reason for it? My laptop specifications are as follows:

- Intel Core 2 Duo 2.53GHz;
 - 2 GB DDR2 800MHz RAM;
 - Intel GM45 chipset;
 - Windows 7;
- Please help

Surabhit Gupta

A Most laptops are designed in such a way that they can't be overclocked as their design does not allow for more heat dissipation than what it was designed to handle using the stock cooler. Some companies actually underclock the CPU to certain level in order to prevent overheating. Because of this it's not advisable to even try overclocking your laptop. Also, most laptops have locked multipliers and that means that it's impossible to overclock them by traditional means. Also, given your configuration, if you somehow find a way to actually overclock your device and you don't end up burning a component or two, the performance gains will be marginal to say the least. There are some high end gaming grade laptops available in the market which may provide some overclocking headroom, but even for these it's not really recommended. Also remember that you void your warranty when you overclock. If you get caught that is.

WiFi woes

Hello, there's a problem in my PC. I have a WiFi connection which works fine

with all my devices and is very fast. But, after I replaced the hard disk drive on my PC. The WiFi signal is low and the internet speed is very less. At the same time the WiFi signal on all other devices I use is fast and the signal strength is full.

Below are my PC specs:

- Intel Core Duo T500 CPU @ 2.1GHz;
- 2038 MB RAM;
- Hardisk 500 GB;
- Windows 7 starter 32-bit

S.Balarishi

A There is no direct relation between replacing a hard drive and the WiFi speed getting choppy unless something went wrong during the process. Perform the following checks to determine where the problem actually lies in your system:

- Since you've recently replaced your hard drive, make sure that you didn't disturb any other component in your system while installation, by checking their connections.
- Next, uninstall your network drivers, restart your PC and reinstall them again. Sometimes internal issues do arise during installation of drivers, making the installed components



Use a brush or an ear-pick to clean inside the laptop